



University center Abdelhafid Boussouf - Mila
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E-Learning unit

English - level 1

– Lesson 5 – English Adjectives

Staff pédagogique

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Etudiants concernés

Institut	Département	Année	Spécialité
-Lettres et Langues étrangères	- Français	-Français	Licence 1
-Sciences et Techniques	-MI- ST	-MI- ST	Licence 1
-Sciences Economique	-SE	-Toutes les spécialités	Licence 1

Objectives of lesson 5

- i. To make students aware of the use of adjectives in a sentence
- ii. To familiarize students with different kinds of adjectives; and
- iii. To enable the students to form the comparatives and the superlatives of adjectives.

1. Definition:

An **adjective** is a part of speech which modifies a noun or a pronoun.

2. Forms of adjectives:

Adjectives have three different forms, **positive**, **comparative**, and **superlative**:

The positive form is the base form of the adjective.

-He is **tall**. / - it's **interesting**.

The comparative form is used for comparing two persons or things; it expresses a higher degree of some quality.

- He is **taller** than me. / - The book was **more interesting** than the film.

The superlative form is used for comparing one person or thing with every other member of their group; it expresses the highest degree.

- He was the **tallest** boy in the class. / - It's the **most interesting** book I've ever read.

2. The rule to form comparatives and superlatives:

Short adjectives (one or two syllables):

1. One-syllable adjective ending in a silent 'e' – **nice**.

- Comparative – add 'r' – **nicer**
- Superlative – add 'st' – **nicest**

2. One syllable adjective ending in one vowel and one consonant – **big**

- Comparative – the consonant is doubled and 'er' is added – **bigger**
- Superlative – the consonant is doubled and 'est' is added – **biggest**

3. One syllable adjective ending in more than one consonant or more than a vowel – **high, cheap**

- Comparative – 'er' is added – **higher, cheaper**
- Superlative – 'est' is added – **highest, cheapest**

4. A two syllable adjective ending in 'y' – **happy**

- Comparative – 'y' becomes 'i' and 'er' is added – **happier**
- Superlative – 'y' becomes 'i' and 'est' is added – **happiest**

Long adjectives (more than two syllables):

- Comparative – more + the adjective + than – **more exciting than**
- Superlative – most+adjectives+'est' – **most exciting**

Irregular comparatives and superlatives

Adjectives	Comparatives	Superlatives
bad	worse	worst
far(distance)	farther	farthest
good	better	best
little	less	least
many	more	most

4. Use of adjectives: attributive or predicative

Adjectives are used in two main ways; they can either be **attributive** or they can be **predicative**.

Attributive adjectives:

When the adjective is used before a noun:

a black cat

Predicative adjectives

Adjectives are said to be predicative when they are used as the complement of the verb 'to be', or other similar verbs such as 'get', 'become', 'grow', 'look', or 'seem', etc.

The cat is black

5. Types of adjectives

There exist several types of adjectives namely:

- 1 / **OPINION** : Nice, ugly, dirty
- 1 / **SIZE** : Large, small, tiny, enormous
- 2 / **AGE** : New, young, old, ancient
- 3 / **SHAPE** : Square, round, rectangular, flat
- 4 / **COLOUR** : Blue, pink, yellow, crimson
- 5 / **ORIGIN** : English, American, Chinese, French
- 6 / **MATERIAL** : Plastic, cardboard, glass, wooden
- 7 / **PURPOSE** : Racing car, frying pan, rocking chair

***Opinion adjectives usually go before fact adjectives

Time for practice

In the following sentences, underline the adjectives and identify the type of each adjective:

1. At home there is a beautiful square wooden table in the dining room.
2. I was offered an unusual gold ring by my husband.
3. My grandmother has knitted a nice new woolen pullover for me.
4. It is really a warm nice weather today.
5. She has beautiful long black hair.

References

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